

The Wisdom of You

By Hilarey Boly

☀ Face Reading Guide

An Introduction to Face Reading and what your features mean.

Have you ever looked in the mirror, into your own eyes and wondered—who am I? What am I doing here?

Our faces - our physical existence is a great mystery for those of us who contemplate such things. For most of human history, we have paid attention to signs. For physical safety and preparation, it makes sense. If the dogs all start barking, it's obvious to wonder why. Or if all the birds go quiet. Why? An early or late spring, has ramifications for the growth season — or the ski season. It is in our nature to pay attention to signs.

In human history, we have also utilized divining tools — the I Ching in China, the tarot deck, or a pendulum, or dowsing rods.

We use our senses and pay attention to patterns.

The body we inhabit is also a springboard — an instrument and tool receiving information from our senses and broadcasting out information as well. In our modern era, we are not typically taught to note signs like these. We get our food from the grocery store and are often a step removed from the natural world. And, it does behoove us to pay attention to signs.

In Taosist, East Asian medicine, it's understood that our bodies are like batteries, positively and negatively charged - each organ system relates to an energy pathway or meridian which also hold and express feelings and emotions.

When we like something, we'll gravitate toward it. If we dislike something, we'll recoil or pull away.

When afraid, we'll pull back and run.

And, our faces are the same - our bone structures and features reveal our inner landscape - our natural inclinations and our faces evolve based on how we respond to various stimuli or experiences.

Maybe you have your mom's nose and your dad's eyebrows? What does that mean?

Who are you really? Is there something *deeper*, ancient and wise in you expressing through your physical expression?

Yes!

Face reading, also known as *physiognomy*, is the art of reading facial features —your lines, your bone structure, the brightness of your eyes, the shape of your ears—which can reveal often hidden insights about your health, personality, emotions, and life path.

Face Reading not about judging appearances as good or bad. In fact, it's the opposite. Face reading invites us to see ourselves and others with more *compassion*, *curiosity*, and *clarity*.

This practice has roots in many cultures.

In **Chinese or Taoist medicine**, it's called *Mien Shiang*, and has been used for over 2,600 years for health diagnosis, career guidance, matchmaking and even destiny.

In **Ayurveda**, it's called *Mukha Samudrika Shastra* - facial features reflect planetary energies and karmic patterns.

Even in **Western science and psychology**, thinkers like Charles Darwin, Rudolf Steiner, and Wilhelm Reich also noticed how physical form reflects internal truth.

Across all these traditions, there is a shared belief: **Your face is meaningful**. It tells the story of your soul's journey through life—your strengths, your struggles, your gifts, and your potential.

How Life Shapes Us: Morphology & Epigenetics

Science seem to agree -

The field of **morphology** studies the structure and form of living things.

So, for example, the shape of your nose or the curve of your cheekbones would be considered morphology.

Then there is **epigenetics**, a newer field of science which considers our environment, our emotions, and life experiences, and how these influence genes expression.

In other words, your DNA gives you a basic blueprint—but how that blueprint is *built* relies on how you live your life (epigenetics)

So you might inherit a tendency toward a certain face shape, but it's your lifestyle, your stress levels, your levels of nourishment, or lack of nourishment, your emotional responses, loving or difficult relationships and your belief systems determine *how* the shapes fully express - in the moment and certainly over the course of time.

An osteopathic doctor once explained that it's the soft tissue of brain growing inside the skull shapes the bones from the inside. Pressure is what causes ossification or the bones to grow. A person with chronic stress may clench their jaw and over time, the muscular tension puts a demand on the joint which connects with the bone. Over time, the jaw widens and hardens into place. This is morphology.

We see this in river rocks, smoothed over time by the constant swoosh of water over the rough points of a stone.

Epigenetics says that if someone experiences high levels of stress in early life—or even in the womb—that stress can change how their body develops. It might influence their height, posture, the tension in their jaw or neck. It can even shape emotional resilience and expressions.

We are, literally, **shaped by life**—and our faces become a living record of it.

Your Face Is a Storybook and Treasure map!

Traditional Chinese face reading tells us that the face reflects our **Shen**—the spirit that animates us.

The brightness in your eyes, the set of your brow, the lift of one's smile or thickness of the lips—these are not just expressions; they are expressions of the spirit, your genetic composition and how we've processed life experiences.

Modern science actually supports this idea. Chronic stress can raise cortisol, which contributes to inflammation, loss of skin elasticity, and changes in our eyes or jaw. Joy, on the other hand, softens the face. Unprocessed trauma can harden various aspects of the body including the face!

So when it's said "your story is written on your face," It's not just poetic—it's also *biological, emotional, and spiritual*.

In Face Reading, we recognize very adaptation is about maneuvering through the world the best way we know how at the time. Face Reading is about recognizing the courage and richness developed in each feature. A wrinkle may hold a decade of laughter or sorrow or some of each. A scar might be a badge of survival. A dimple might be a soul's tendency towards charm and playfulness.

A Global Practice Rooted in Spirit

Face reading has traveled across centuries and continents, showing up in many different forms:

- In **China**, it guided emperors in choosing advisors, doctors in diagnosing illness, and matchmakers in selecting ideal partners.
- In **India**, Ayurveda and astrology combined to map the face as a divine compass.
- In the **West**, Rudolf Steiner taught that the body, including the face, is a vessel of the spirit, reflecting one's destiny and inner growth.
- Wilhelm Reich, a visionary psychoanalyst, believed that facial expressions and body language could be "read" to understand emotional patterns—long before neuroscience confirmed the mind-body link.

Some modern schools of face reading, such as the **Lotus Institute** and teachings of **Lillian Pearl Bridges**, also suggest we face readers "mirror" the expression— better understand the expression and how it feels in the reader to express that way - To stand in the other's experience for just a moment.

The face is also a timeline. Chinese face readers divide it into three zones:

- **Heaven (Upper):** The forehead, representing ancestry, early life, and spiritual connection
- **Human (Middle):** The nose, eyes, and cheeks, representing personal power, relationships, and the middle years of life
- **Earth (Lower):** The jaw and chin, reflecting grounding, willpower, and the later years of life

Each line is a memory, each mole a marker. The eyes reveal vitality, clarity, and emotional presence. The nose shows self-worth and power; the lips show communication and sensuality, reveal how we process food and life; the ears reflect inherited constitution and levels of stamina and energy.

This practice asks us to pause before making assumptions and instead listen to the subtle language of the body. In doing so, we come into closer contact with both ourselves and others—not as fixed types or categories, but as beings in process, in motion, and in meaning

The Body as Biography – Wilhelm Reich and Character Structure

In 20th-century Europe, Wilhelm Reich—a student of Freud—offered a groundbreaking perspective on the body as a living archive of emotional history. Reich believed that every unresolved emotion left a physical imprint on the body, forming what he called "muscular armor." This armor, developed in childhood is shaped by life experience, shows up in the way we hold our shoulders, clench our jaws, or furrow our brows.

Reich's insight gave birth to the study of character structures: habitual ways of holding the body and expressing the self. Later thinkers such as Alexander Lowen and John Pierrakos expanded this work into five primary types:

- **Schizoid:** Energetically withdrawn, physically tense, often with asymmetrical features or a sense of disconnection between head and body.
- **Oral:** Expressive and emotionally open but often yearning for nurturing; soft features, round cheeks, pouty lips.
- **Masochistic:** Controlled and contained, with tension in the jaw, neck, and pelvis; a face that may seem held or heavy.

- **Psychopathic:** Charismatic yet guarded; strong facial features, intense gaze, often high cheekbones and a bold jawline.
- **Rigid:** Perfectionistic and poised; a symmetrical face, firm expression, and tightly held muscles.

These body types are not static identities, but adaptive responses to early relational patterns. Each reflects a way of surviving emotionally and physically—and just like in Mian Xiang, the face becomes the mirror of these internal currents.

Where Chinese Face Reading sees the body through the lens of elemental balance and Qi flow, Reich's model views the body through trauma, attachment, and psychological defense. Both systems, however, agree: **the body tells the truth**—sometimes even before we know it ourselves.

By learning to see these patterns with empathy and clarity, we begin to recognize not only others more deeply, but our own hidden stories waiting to be known and released.

Chapter 3: Form as Expression – Rudolf Steiner and the Spiritual Anatomy of the Human Being

Rudolf Steiner, the Austrian mystic and founder of Anthroposophy, saw the human body—especially the face—as a revelation of the soul's development and spiritual path. His work invited people to view the form not just through biology or psychology, but as the outer reflection of an inner becoming.

Steiner spoke of the **threefold human being**:

1. **Nerve-Sense System** – Located in the head, associated with **thinking** and consciousness. Cool, spatial, and reflective.
2. **Rhythmic System** – Centered in the chest and lungs, linked to **feeling**. Warm, dynamic, and breathing.
3. **Metabolic-Limb System** – Found in the limbs and digestion, connected to **willing**. Hot, active, and expressive.

In the face, this trinity expresses itself clearly:

- The **forehead and eyes** reflect thought and perception
- The **nose and cheeks** express emotional life and vitality
- The **jaw and mouth** reveal will, speech, and action in the world

To Steiner, **the face was not fixed**, but ever-shifting—an outward echo of karma, soul expression, and spiritual striving. He believed that facial features evolve over a lifetime and are shaped by both ancestral forces and personal choices.

Steiner also emphasized the significance of **gesture, gaze, and posture**. A person's look, the way they stand or move, even how they listen—all were clues to their inner orientation. Like Chinese Face Reading's concept of Shen, Steiner taught that the **eyes were the soul's windows**, offering a direct glimpse into spiritual presence or depletion.

In Waldorf education, which he founded, Steiner encouraged teachers to observe students' facial expressions and body language not to diagnose, but to **nurture their development**. Similarly, in Anthroposophic medicine, facial cues help practitioners understand the harmony—or disharmony—between the spiritual and physical realms.

Steiner's lens brings a moral and spiritual sensitivity to face reading. It doesn't aim to categorize but to witness, to sense the unfolding biography of the soul made visible through flesh.

His work, like Reich's and the ancient Chinese masters', reminds us that the **body is not just something we have—it's something we become**.

In the Language of Taoist Alchemy:

In Taoist philosophy, three essential ideas help us understand how our face and body reflect our journey:

- **Ming** – Your destiny or soul contract.
- **Jing** – Your DNA or blueprint, your genetic inheritance.
- **Shen** – Your spirit and awareness. The light of you.
- **Qi** - your energy, and ability to make things happen - made from food and breath. We can also make qi through cultivation exercises like qi gong or yoga.

Epigenetics is what happens in the space between these—where biology and spirit meet, where life responds to experience.

In the Language of Tao and Chinese Medicine:

- **Ming (Destiny)** is your original blueprint (like DNA).
- **Xing (Form)** is how that destiny unfolds in real life (morphology).
- Shen (Spirit) and spirit expression - Your **life choices and experiences** (lifestyle, emotions, spiritual connection) either **support or distort** that unfolding—this is epigenetics in action.

This guide focuses on face reading through the lens of Taoist alchemy - as philosophical or spiritual practice - understanding our faces as opportunity to harmonize body, mind and spirit toward longevity, wisdom and fulfillment of destiny.

Face Reading based on Taoist Wisdom invites us to look more deeply at (and into) ourselves - our features, our shapes, our markings, to live our unique path utilizing our divinely gifted face (and body) which holds inherited traits, talents and the resources needed to be who we are destined to be!

Each face is a treasure - with a story to tell, a story shaped by experience, emotion and genetic gifts.

Visualize an enormous gemstone with many facets. Each facet is a face, a perspective and a necessary contribution toward the beauty and the illumination of the gem. This gem, is God's crown jewel and achievement.

Thank you for being the contribution you are, a beautiful illuminates soul who makes the world a better place.

By deeply looking at ourselves and others with compassion, we can foster deeper connections and achieve our life purpose and realize our destiny!

My teacher, Lillian Pearl Bridges emphasized face reading from a holistic perspective - that though some face readers say there are 'good' and 'bad' features, she emphasized history and how such judgements were made. For example, often the first Chinese/Western connections

were made on the Silk Road. Traveling Westerners generally were adventurous types and probably tended toward larger noses than Chinese people. And, though not all tradesmen were unscrupulous businessmen, invariably, some were, thus large noses were viewed negatively and some of these biases remain.

You Are a Living Jewel

This book is a guide, yes. And, it is an *invitation*.

An invitation to see yourself—*really see yourself*—through eyes of wisdom, curiosity, and grace.

Your face is you.

Your features are divinely chiseled.

They are messages. Markers. Stories written by time, experience, inheritance, and purpose.

Visualize a great gemstone, glittering in the light. Each facet reflects something new. Each person, each face, is one of those facets—together forming a luminous, divine whole.

When we learn to read the face, we learn to speak the language of the soul. We become better listeners—to others, and to ourselves.

Thank you for being here.

Thank you for being exactly who you are, and for being curious enough to explore the ancient map of your own face.

In these next chapters, we'll explore the Five Elements—Wood, Fire, Earth, Metal, and Water—as seen through facial features, personality traits, emotional tendencies, and spiritual lessons. You'll learn to see the world and yourself with new eyes.

Face reading isn't just a skill.

It's a way of life.

It's a sacred act of remembering.

~ The Elements ~

Chinese Face Reading and the Elements:

Wood Element

Eyebrows & Temples · Vision · Growth

Wood is the energy of spring—new beginnings, upward movement, and fresh ideas. It's all about direction, planning, and growth. Think of trees stretching toward the sky or kids testing limits, a person pushing their endurance to reach a goal.

In the body, Wood is linked to the Liver and Gallbladder. These organs help us manage emotions, make decisions, and keep things moving. When Wood is strong, we're creative, courageous, and driven by purpose.

Wood types are often natural leaders—bold, visionary, and passionate about justice. But when out of balance, Wood can become frustrated, impatient, or rigid.

Support Wood by:

- Moving your body—stretch, walk, dance
- Journaling and planning
- Releasing anger in healthy ways
- Avoiding alcohol and greasy food - which stagnate the liver and work the gallbladder hard.
- Staying flexible in mind and body

Face Zone: Eyebrows show your drive and direction. Thick or sparse, straight or wild—they all tell a story about your inner momentum.

Taoist Wisdom: Wood houses the **Hun**, our Ethereal Soul—the dreamer within. It guides our visions and night dreams, helping us imagine and reach for what's next.

Fire Element

Eyes & Tips · Joy · Connection

Fire is summer energy—bright, warm, alive. It's the force of love, laughter, and heartfelt expression. Fire types light up a room and crave meaningful connection.

Fire is linked to the Heart, Small Intestine, Pericardium, and San Jiao. It governs joy, discernment, emotional boundaries, and circulation. A healthy Fire makes us feel radiant, spiritually connected, and emotionally in tune.

When Fire is excessive, we may feel anxious, overstimulated, or burnt out. If it's low, we can become cold, withdrawn, or lonely.

Support Fire by:

- Spending time with loved ones
- Laughing and playing
- Meditating or resting the mind
- Avoiding late nights and stimulants
- Living from the heart - when making a decision, how does it feel? Go with that.

Face Zone: Eyes, nose tip, and features with points show Fire. Sparkly eyes, flushed cheeks, freckles and expressive features often reveal a strong Fire nature.

Taoist Wisdom: Fire houses the **Shen**, our Spirit. It brings clarity, love, and presence. A bright Shen is a spark of life you can feel.

Earth Element

Mouth & Lips · Nurturing · Stability

Earth is late summer energy—centered, calm, and nourishing. It's the energy of caretaking, digestion (physical and emotional), and grounded support.

Earth governs the Spleen and Stomach, helping us process food, thoughts, and feelings. Balanced Earth gives us compassion, reliability, and a strong sense of home—both within and around us.

Too much Earth can feel like worry, over-caretaking, or clinginess. Too little may show up as scattered thinking or feeling unsupported.

Support Earth by:

- Eating warm, nourishing foods
- Giving and receiving support
- Creating routines and boundaries
- Grounding through nature or touch

Face Zone: Lips and mouth speak to how we nourish and relate. Full lips often show generosity and care; tight lips may hint at withheld emotion, self control or self-protection.

Taoist Wisdom: Earth is about the center. When we are home in ourselves, we can offer nourishment to others.

Metal Element

Nose & Cheeks · Value · Integrity

Metal is autumn energy—crisp, reflective, and refined. It helps us let go of what no longer serves and hold on to what's most precious.

Metal governs the Lungs and Large Intestine, managing breath, inspiration, and elimination. It's about grief, clarity, self-worth, and honor.

Balanced Metal brings a deep sense of purpose and value. When out of balance, it can turn rigid, overly perfectionistic, or emotionally distant.

Support Metal by:

- Deep breathing and breathwork
- Letting go—clutter, habits, grief, negativity
- Embracing ritual and beauty
- Practicing self-worth and enjoying beauty.

Face Zone: Nose and cheeks reflect how we value ourselves and others. Prominent cheekbones and a defined nose often show strength in leadership and integrity.

Taoist Wisdom: Metal connects us to the sacred. It reminds us that through loss and refinement, we discover what truly shines.

Water Element

Ears & Jaw · Wisdom · Flow

Water is the energy of winter—deep, still, and powerful. It holds our reserves, instincts, and ancestral wisdom. Water types are intuitive, private, powerful, resilient.

Water is linked to the Kidneys and Bladder. It governs fear, survival, willpower, and the ability to go deep and inward. Balanced Water brings trust in the unknown and the strength to endure.

When out of balance, Water may show up as fear, isolation, or exhaustion—or a constant push to “do” without enough rest.

Support Water by:

- Resting deeply and often
- Honoring alone time and reflection
- Listening to your intuition
- Keeping warm in winter, cool in summer and hydrated

Face Zone: Ears and jaw show your reserves and inner strength. Strong jaws and large ears often point to powerful determination and inherited wisdom. Small jaw or ears suggest the particular need to pace yourself and honor the need to rest when it calls.

Taoist Wisdom: Water holds the **Zhi**, our willpower and drive to survive. When strong, it gives us courage in the face of the unknown.

The Fundamental Features of the Face

How the Landscape of Your Face Tells Your Story

Your face is like a map—that's been drawn over time, by both your inner responses to your experiences. It holds memory, meaning, and potential. Let's take a journey across this landscape, beginning with some of the foundational features most often explored in face reading traditions.

Lillian made a point to prepare her students for face reading by reminding us that this is deep energetic work. She herself acknowledged her own body dysmorphia and her own harsh self critic and her approach emphasized the importance of not just kindness but empowerment. Features are never bad or even “good” — it's always what we do with them — they are resources. Face readings should be positive and empowering for the recipient and you!

Before all the specifics facial features, when we look at another person, what do we notice first?

For me, it is usually an energetic impression - often to do with the eyes. For example, when meeting the eyes, there's an impression that arises. The first thing I notice or feel.

It is often the eyes but may be a different feature.

It's often the look in the eyes of the emotion in or behind the eyes, which will then inspire the intake of other information.

Maybe it's a feeling of openness or sadness, and which leads me to look for affirmation of this - is this a momentary expression, or has it settled in the face - are the eyes downward tilting? Are there sorrow lines, what are their lips like? Or, maybe the person feels very direct when I look in their eyes — are the eyes close set or farther apart? Maybe their eyes are small and focused which would affirm the directness. Does the person have lines around the eyes, suggesting that the emotions have likely become habitual.

The size of the eyes suggests how open a person is, how much they want to or are able to connect.

The eyes:

What I notice first — do you ?

If the face is a landscape, the eyes are like the lakes and in many landscape images, if there's a water feature, it's what is ingested first. The consciousness or Shen is read first — and offers impression in terms of how a person might receive the information. If a person is coming to you for a face reading, they are typically receptive.

What's your first impression or intuitive hit?

How open are the eyes? This reveals how emotionally open the person is. How present? Can you connect?

It has to do with space apart as well — is a person wide and open? Wide spaced eyes? — he takes the larger perspective.

Eyes that are deep set are people who are probably more internal, whereas eyes that are not are more external — to determine this, if a pencil were to sit on the brow bone vertically, would the eyeball touch the pencil (external) or not (deeper set)

The Eyes: Windows to the Soul

The eyes are one of the most revealing features of the face. They show emotional depth, presence, and how a person sees the world—literally and metaphorically.

- **Large eyes** reflect emotional openness, curiosity, and sensitivity. These are the people who feel deeply and likely wear their hearts close to the surface.
- **Small eyes** suggest focus, discernment, and attention to detail. These individuals may be more inward and private but possess a quiet strength.
- **Dark circles or puffiness** under the eyes may point to emotional burdens or stress—especially in Chinese medicine, where this area is related to the Water Element and kidney-adrenal health. It's a sign of energy being depleted or held in. Lillian called under eye bags “unshed tears.” In this case, the person has emotions that need to come out — to feel the emotions inside
- **Eyes that slant upward** on the end - Optimistic outlook
- **Eyes that slant downward** - sad tendency, ‘sad eyes’ - a person who can feel the pain of others or tends to be sadness.
- Eye distance - if the ‘space between the eyes’ is larger than the eye itself, or smaller than the length of one eye:
- Close set eyes - attention to details. They have a ‘narrow focus’ - often meticulous with details and able to focus.
- Wide set eyes - these are big picture people - they can take in broad information. I call this type of person a ‘generalist’ - able to take in a lot of information and have a more ‘horizontal view’ of things

The Forehead: Intellect and Thinking Patterns

The forehead reflects the mind—how you think, process, and perceive information. The forehead is where we see intellect, memory, decision-making, and how you handled the formative early adult years.

I imagine the forehead as a movie screen. The bigger, or more prominent the forehead, the larger the screen and the more space a person has to receive information or images. In terms of psychic ability, these people are more likely to receive images or information

- **A high forehead or long** (more than 4 of their fingers width) often points to a natural intelligence and strong analytical skills. People with this feature may be thoughtful and future-oriented. These people enjoy ‘thinking’ - they like ideas, theories, equations, and information generally. If sensitive, these people may also be psychic.

- **A wide forehead** suggests creativity, adaptability, and a spaciousness of mind. These individuals often think “outside the box” and adapt easily to new situations.
- **Horizontal lines or wrinkles** on the forehead often appear in the late teens to twenties and reflect the emotional and intellectual challenges faced during that time. Each line is a story—an initiation. Think of them as markers of life experience and transformation, not signs of aging.
- **Short forehead** suggests a more practical person with good kinesthetic sense. They learn by doing! These people aren’t as interested in theories or lofty information, they tend to be more embodied and learn best experientially. In terms of psychic ability, a short forehead person would likely receive an embodied knowing sense.

BROW BONES - if a person has brow bones that are strong, it suggests a stubbornness and an ability to ‘hold one’s own’. Lillian said she was told by her mother “you don’t listen to me” - She said that she listened - she heard what her mother was saying. However, she wanted to do it her way and didn’t necessarily follow advice - certainly not if it didn’t make sense to her. She attributed this trait to having a strong brow bone. Bones ossify under pressure and bones of the face suggest independence and an unwillingness to ‘comply’ in the face of pressure. Strong brow bones point to ‘hardening’ or firming in the face of adversity, being able to ‘take a stand’ when needed.

The Eyebrows: Decision making and Liver Health

The Wood Element. The eyebrows are the “leaves of the tree”

The eyebrows point to the health of the liver - how you make decision and make things happen.

The liver is the major detoxification organ, it filters the blood. The liver rules vision and is about hope and moving forward in life. It’s springtime energy of birth and growth.

- Thick eyebrows - good liver health and good stamina for physical actions. These people enjoy and need a challenge. They can process toxins.
- Thin or sparse eyebrows - these people are more sensitive and can get overwhelmed by too many demands requiring physical energy or even demanding people. These people would be wise to avoid drugs or alcohol or even erring on the side of conservative doses of herbal supplements.
- Short eyebrows suggest someone who may not like to make decisions or as Taoist Priest, Jeffrey Yuen suggests, they may make quicker decisions. If the eyebrows stop before reaching the line of the outer eye, this can also point to thyroid health issues or hypothyroidism.
- Smooth arched eyebrows, this is a harmonious person who tends to be pleasing and can smooth out strife “courtesan eyebrows”
- Pointed Arched eyebrows tend to be associated with ambition and the ability to make precise decisions!
- Long flat eyebrows - these people may need time when making decisions - it can take them a while before they decide - they are also probably fairly even temperamentally.
- Eyebrows that grow downward can be associated with depression or serious or heavy temperament.
- Eyebrows that grow in an upward direction are associated with self esteem and optimism.
- Eyebrows that are wild, these people tend to go their own way and maybe unpredictably so.

The Nose: Ambition, Confidence, and Power

In many traditions, the nose is a central marker of personal power, career ambition, and how we assert ourselves in the world.

- **A straight, prominent nose** suggests leadership, self-assurance, and the ability to make things happen as well as leadership ability. In considering facial features and work positions, the prominent nose would be a natural leader — willing to take risks and lead. I think of the nose as the major mountain of the face. A good

leader is one who is willing to put themselves at risk - carving or blazing the trail - ensuring safe passage for the people in their expedition. Bonus leadership ability, if the nose has a bump!

- **A bulbous nose** (particularly at the tip) may indicate a strong appreciation for life's pleasures and comforts. These people tend to be collectors—of objects, relationships or memories.
- **A hooked or aquiline nose** is often associated with strategic thinking, wisdom, and royal lineage. It's a feature seen in many influential people, reflecting resilience and a long view on life.
- **A bump on the bridge** can signal extra leadership ability—often seen in individuals who carry a sense of responsibility or who have stepped into leadership roles, even if reluctantly. Observationally, these risk takers usually have an great kinesthetic sense and are adepts in most things they take on. They like goals and can achieve them.
- Small or flat nose tends toward collaboration and harmony. These are community oriented people who are willing to work methodically and tirelessly in support of their families and the people they love. Smart leaders create 'home like' environments for the collaborator types because these worker bees, when they feel appreciated and connected with their communities, truly make the community a better place for everyone.

The Mouth: Communication and Sensual Experience, how we invest and process experiences.

The mouth tells us how a person communicates, expresses emotion, and engages with the pleasures of life. It also reflects one's ability to receive and give nourishment.

- **Full lips** suggest expressiveness, warmth, and a love for sensory experience—food, touch, beauty, connection.
- Many years ago, I had an acupuncture patient, a woman who had the most beautiful, full lips. She was in the midst of a spiritual transformation and had adopted an extremely minimalist diet. She ate only what was necessary to survive, guided by a belief in causing no harm—not even to plants. She *loved* feeding the deer that visited her yard. There was such tenderness in her spirit, and her lips told the story of a soul attuned to the sacredness of life, even as she hesitated consuming too much, she still experienced earthly joys, by feeding the animals and connecting with their spirits. She reminded me of St. Francis of Assisi—innocent, gentle, and deeply connected to the natural world. Other face readers might call these hedonistic lips. I associate hedonism with the love of pleasure at the expense of others. This is a short sighted interpretation, in my opinion.
- **Thin lips** may indicate restraint, practicality, or a more reserved emotional nature. These individuals often value precision and may find joy in smaller, subtler ways. And, thin lips are a call: encourage this person to explore savoring life more fully, let yourself savor tastes and speak more freely. Get out in nature and be present to the beauty around you! If you want to 'grow lips,' practice enjoying more passionate kissing!
- Smaller or narrow mouth with full lips: The ability to enjoy sensual pleasures in modest doses. If a person has a smaller mouth and midsized lips, there's the suggestion to enjoy pleasures but to also be aware of how we digest food and experiences.
- **Upturned corners of the mouth** reflects a natural optimism or a cheerful approach to life.
- **Downturned mouth** doesn't necessarily mean someone is unhappy—it may indicate seriousness, pensiveness, or a life shaped by sorrow that deepened their soul.
- **Wide Mouth** - ability to ingest a lot — These people can eat a big meal or enjoy a lot of life, and have the ability to talk a lot.
- **Small Mouth** - tendency toward smaller meals and more throughout the day. Enjoy little pleasures.

 *Practice tip:* If you're unsure what a particular expression means, try making that same expression yourself. What emotion arises in your own body? This simple mirroring practice builds empathy and attunement—key tools for any face reader.

The Ears: Receptivity, Intuition, and Childhood Years

Ears give clues about early influences, listening ability, and how someone processes intuitive information.

- **Large ears** are associated with strong constitution, openness to guidance, and the ability to absorb wisdom. In many traditions, they are considered a symbol of *good fortune and longevity*—think of the big ears on statues of the Buddha.
- **Small ears**: are associated with energy and constitution - and the wisdom of conservation. A person with smaller ears is probably not interested in taking physical risks like skydiving or pushing endurance limits. It's wise to honor one's interest in physical activity — it might be a good to ask about. physical movement feels good, do that. If you feel tired after, note that and choose movements that feel right for you.
- **Protruding ears** These are people who speak with power. It's a trait often seen in strong orators and can be excellent public speakers. Barak Obama is a good example of protruding ears and he's a skilled orator.
- **Ears close to the head** reflect a persona who is a good listener. I once face read for a man who had close set ears. He was proud of his work as a reporter and said the ability to listen served him well in this role, because he was a good listener!
- **Ears that slant backwards** are unique thinkers - they think for themselves and potentially in unusual ways - they may hear information not necessarily said - but perhaps implied or even able to hear what's being hidden or untrue.
- **Large earlobes** point to later life and being well cared for by loved ones.
- Lines in front of the ears: BS detectors. People with these lines can tell if information is truthful or Bologna.

The Chin and Jawline: Willpower and Endurance

The lower part of the face represents how we act in the world—our follow-through, our drive, and how we respond to challenges.

- **A strong or prominent jawline** reveals courage, athleticism, and determination. These individuals tend to face difficulty head-on and are rarely deterred by obstacles. Perhaps like strong eyebrows the person with a strong jaw can make things happen and use their will to move not just heavy objects but spiritually, too, they can work through hard things. There can be a stubbornness and forthrightness as well.
- **A soft or receding chin** doesn't mean weakness—it can indicate flexibility, spiritual detachment, or a preference for harmony over force. These people may flow rather than push, bend rather than break.
- A Short lower third of the face, suggests this aspect of life - the will isn't as dominant. These people may not be as grounded or 'Stubborn' - perhaps having more of an emphasis in ideas or day to day practicality
- A long lower third of the face, suggests more roundedness and an ability to "hold your ground" as well as deep resources.
- A pointed or longer horizontal chin suggest deep tap roots - the ability to hold position and stability in situations
- A wide jaw suggests 'roots' that are more broad and stretch into other areas. Tap root VS the fibrous root system - they can hold soil and may be less stubborn and yet stable.

Each face is a unique constellation of inherited traits, shaped by personal experience. There is no "ideal" face. There is only *your* face.

When we begin to see each feature not as good or bad, but as *symbolic*, *functional*, and *meaningful*, we shift from judgment to wisdom. We start to read faces not with criticism, but with reverence.

Let your eyes, your nose, your mouth, your whole face become your teacher. It knows things about you you've forgotten. It remembers what you were born with, and what life has made of you. And it holds the key to what's still possible.